

Vinh Ly

Palo Alto, CA | vily437@outlook.com | (318) 202-8037 | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/vinh-ly-14b56b50>

Summary

Staff software engineer with **14 years** building distributed backend systems and full-stack web applications at Google, YouTube, and Whatnot. Focused on **Python** for backend services, with significant work in **Node.js** and **React** frontends. Led teams and shipped features relied on by hundreds of millions of users. Solid grasp of the full development lifecycle from design through production, with a track record of owning services end-to-end.

Core Skills

Languages: Python, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Java, C#, Go

Frontend: React, Vue.js, HTML/CSS, SASS

Backend: Node.js, Django, Flask, FastAPI, Express

Data: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB

Infra: Docker, Kubernetes, GCP, AWS

Tooling: Git, CI/CD, Prometheus, Grafana

Education

BS Computer Science | University of Texas at Austin | 2007 - 2011

Work Experience

Staff Software Engineer | YouTube | Remote | 02/2025-Present

- Building and maintaining backend services that power video delivery at YouTube scale. Working across **Python** microservices and API layers.
- Reduced API response time significantly during peak load by profiling bottlenecks and refactoring the request path.
- Mentoring two junior engineers on backend design patterns and code review practices.

Staff Software Engineer | Whatnot | Hybrid | 05/2024-02/2025

- Full-stack feature work across the live commerce platform, building **React** frontends backed by **Node.js** APIs, with **Python** services handling business logic.
- Owned the auction bidding service. Took over after reliability issues during high-traffic live events; p99 latency dropped from around 2 s to under 200 ms.
- Collaborated with product managers and designers to ship the checkout redesign, which cut cart abandonment noticeably during the first month.

Staff Software Engineer/Manager | Google | Hybrid | 03/2015 - 04/2024

- Led a team of 5 engineers building core infrastructure for search and advertising systems. Owned the roadmap, design reviews, and on-call rotation for a service handling a large fraction of Google's query volume.
- Introduced a code-review checklist and pair-programming rotation for the team. Cut production regressions by about a third over the following two quarters.
- Managed performance reviews, hiring pipelines, and career development for four direct reports.

Software Engineer | Google | Remote | 02/2011 - 02/2015

- Worked on backend systems for internal developer tooling, primarily in **Python** and Java. Wrote services that automated testing and deployment workflows for other engineering teams.
- Rebuilt a slow data pipeline in **Python** and **Node.js**; query time dropped from several minutes to under 30 seconds for the most common reports.

Software Design Engineer II | Microsoft | Remote | 10/2007 - 12/2011

- Built and maintained test frameworks for Windows components in C# and **Python**. Worked closely with the Windows kernel team to triage and file bugs during feature milestones.
- Shipped tooling used internally by the Windows product team for automated regression detection. Reduced manual testing overhead for one team by roughly 40%.

Software Design Engineer Intern | Microsoft | Remote | 06/2006 - 08/2006

- Summer internship on the Windows Desktop team. Built a small **Python** script to automate a recurring manual QA task, which the team adopted for the rest of the release cycle.